

## PROTOCOL

1. For each sample, **top-label a PCR tube** with the name indicated on the labsheet.
2. Set up each sample, in order:
  - 8 loading dye (tube marked **LOAD**)
  - 3 PCR product
  - **LOAD has to be fresh – made within 2 days.** The stain does not keep. If it is older, make a new aliquot: **100  $\mu$ L blue juice + 1  $\mu$ L dye** in an Eppendorf tube, labelled **LOAD**.
  - **Marker, one per section:** 8  $\mu$ L loading dye into a tube of marker (yellow).
3. **Mix, quick spin.**
4. Cut a **1% gel slab** with enough wells for all samples, the marker, and a few spare.
5. Place it in the rig, fill with **1 $\times$  TAE** to just cover it, and brace it with the plastic wedge.
6. Load **9  $\mu$ L** per well with a P20, in labsheet order.
7. Lid and leads on: **run to red** – load at the black end.
8. Run at **175 V** for about **10 min. Do not set a timer and walk away** – check every minute or so and stop when the blue front is **2/3–3/4 down the gel**.
9. Image it on the imager **through the orange filter**, with a label strip above the gel. Name the file by date and time, and upload it.